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The Editor
Computers & Operations Research

Dear Editor,

Please find enclosed the second revision of our manuscript CAOR-D-26-01885, *"Optimal-stopping recourse for vehicle routing with simultaneous pickup, delivery, and stochastic demands."* We thank you and the reviewers for the second round of reports. Reviewer 1 considers the principal concerns resolved; Reviewer 2 asked us to align several methodological claims and implementation descriptions with the evidence, and Reviewer 3 asked four clarifying questions. Every comment is answered in the enclosed response letter, and a version of the manuscript with the changes marked against revision 1 is provided.

The main changes are the following.

- The state-conditional variant of the policy is now described as an approximation, with the information it retains and a condition for the monotonicity of its fresh-start value, checked empirically.
- The discussion of the fresh-start bias defines its estimands, reports bootstrap intervals and limits its conclusions to what the evidence supports; the reference programs are labelled separately.
- Two conventions in the evaluation code were corrected (fully loaded departures keep zero slack; the physical post-return state is capped at an empty vehicle) and the affected experiments were re-run. No conclusion changed.
- The day-type experiment, the statistical wording, the over-triggering bound and the exact benchmark (now with a grid-refinement check) are stated more precisely, and the answers to Reviewer 3's questions are reflected in the text and in one table.
- The repository states of the submitted versions are tagged, so the code can be checked against each version under review.

The revised manuscript has not been published previously and is not under consideration elsewhere. The authors have no conflicts of interest to declare.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely, on behalf of all authors,

Quang-Vinh Dang (corresponding author)
British University Vietnam